

Logitech WingMan Gamepad

Features: Excellent tilt motion sensor, 11 programmable buttons, one D-pad, one macro button, USB interface **Price:** Rs 2,999
Contact: Aditya Infotech Ltd **Phone:** 022-26338555
E-mail: sunil_zarekar@adityagroup.com
Web site: www.logitech.com

Logitech has carved a name for itself over the years by setting a standard of sorts for all the features a device should have. The Extreme wears stunning blue transparent buttons and D-pad on its black body. The six standard buttons are placed in two rows. A small dual colour LED indicates the status of the tilt sensor. The winning feature is the motion sensor control—the gamepad senses your motion and takes the directional input for the pad. However, the analog controller is sorely missed.

The installation is fairly simple as it supports both, a game port and a USB port. WingMan Profiler, the bundled software, provides a simple graphical interface to program the buttons and calibrate the gamepad as per your preferences. You can even download profiles for your favourite game directly from the company's Web site. It brings along a demo version of *Rogue Squadron3D Elite Missions*.

With good support for game profiles and user-friendly software, this device is more suited to serious gamers, considering that it costs Rs 2,999.

Logitech Extreme		B+
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Ergonomics	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶	

Microsoft Sidewinder Game Pad

Features: Eight programmable buttons, one D-pad, USB interface
Price: Rs 700 **Contact:** Trifen Technologies
Phone: 022-26236061/6226777 **E-mail:** trifen@vsnl.com
Web site: www.microsoft.com

This Microsoft gamepad is dull grey in colour with black buttons and D-pad. The first major difference from the earlier pads is that the sloping body has been replaced by a flat one and the handles have been shortened.

The button layout is similar to the older versions and is tweaked for maximum comfort and efficiency.

The D-pad was the only let-down—it is quite hard, has a very restricted motion and lacks tactile feel. The new features include a mode button and a USB interface; a small green LED indicates the power status.

The sidewinder can be connected to the USB port using its long cable. It does not bring along any software, taking for granted that every user will be running Windows 98 or the Me operating system. The installation is quite hassle-free and the calibration can be done from the game controller settings in the control panel.

The price tag is the real clincher—the gamepad costs only Rs 700—a package hard to ignore.

Microsoft SideWinder					
Features					
Build quality					
Ergonomics					
Value for money					
OVERALL					

Logitech WingMan Rumble Pad

Features: Rumble effects, two analog stick controllers, a slider throttle, 11 programmable buttons, one D-pad **Price:** Rs 2,599
Contact: Aditya Infotech Ltd **Phone:** 022-26338555 **E-mail:** sunil_zarekar@adityagroup.com **Web site:** www.logitech.com

The Logitech WingMan Rumble Pad is just the old Logitech joystick with a few enhancements in a different moulding. The first thing to catch the eye is the well-spaced layout of the buttons and controllers.

The buttons need a firm push to work, but the analog sticks are very accurate, smooth and responsive. The slider throttle was a bit loose and lacked the stiffness, but offered good control over the throttle, especially in flight simulators. The rumble effects can be toggled by the rumble button. The mode button can be used to switch between the analog and digital mode.

The rumble effects were appropriately stimulated by every game detail. It can be connected using the long cable to a USB port and does not support a game port. The installation and calibration was a breeze with the accompanying WingMan Profiler utility.

This joystick is priced at Rs 2,599, which is quite reasonable for a feature-rich device.

Logitech WingMan Rumble Pad						A-
Features						
Build quality						
Ergonomics						
Value for money						
OVERALL						

Microsoft SideWinder Plug and Play Game Pad

Features: USB interface, six programmable buttons, one D-pad
Price: Rs 700 **Contact:** Trifen Technologies
Phone: 022-26236061/6226777 **E-mail:** trifen@vsnl.com
Web site: www.microsoft.com

This SideWinder gamepad is the most basic offering from the software giant. The first thing to hit you is the unusual design—the body shell is made up of hard plastic with strips to make it stiff that create a striation effect. The build quality is sturdy with no squeaks even after a good thrashing. The body is slightly tilted on either side, with the D-pad on one side and the four buttons on the other. The triggers are placed just under the control of your first finger and they provide an excellent tactile feel.

This SideWinder features an eight-way D-pad, four programmable buttons and two triggers. Surprisingly, the D-pad does not provide good control in all directions due to a slackness in its operation. The buttons are placed well within the reach of small hands and the triggers offer precise control. This is a plug-and-play USB device that gets automatically detected once the drivers are installed. What makes this product an excellent buy is the fact that Microsoft has taken every small detail into consideration to offer a very comfortable device for just Rs 700.

Microsoft SideWinder Game Pad Plug and Play B+	
Features	► ► ► ► ►
Build quality	► ► ► ► ►
Ergonomics	► ► ► ► ►
Value for money	► ► ► ► ►
OVERALL	► ► ► ► ►

Microsoft SideWinder Game Pad Plug and Play B+	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Ergonomics	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶